Board meeting · Q2 2026

Open Door Shelter

We ran near capacity all quarter — and the board must decide on a second building today.

What this board meeting covers.

01 Where we stand — programs and finance

02 Demand and outcomes this quarter

03 The strategic plan

04 Decision — the second shelter

05 Governance and next steps

We hit our outcomes and held our reserve — and turn-aways are now forcing the board's hand.

Bottom line up front: occupancy held at 95% and 73% of guests moved into housing, with 5.2 months of reserve intact. But we turned away 210 people this quarter, and a second building is available on Elm Street now.

- A strong, clean quarter — outcomes on plan, finances audited and stable.
- One time-boxed decision: lease the Elm Street building now, or wait for the campaign.

Where we stand · Q2 2026

Programs ran near capacity and finances stayed on plan.

142

Nightly beds filled

CAPACITY 150 · 95% ✓ ON PLAN BOARD

73%

Guests placed in housing

TARGET 70% ✓ ON PLAN PROGRAMS

$2.1M

Operating reserve

5.2 MONTHS RUNWAY ✓ ON PLAN FINANCE

Demand · Q2 2026

Demand outran our 150 beds for most of the quarter.

Counts cover April through June; turn-aways are unique individuals, not nightly repeats.

12,940
NIGHTS OF SHELTER

95%
AVERAGE OCCUPANCY

73%
PLACED IN HOUSING

210
PEOPLE TURNED AWAY

At 95% occupancy, we are out of room — and the people we turn away have nowhere else.

A shelter running this full has no slack for a cold snap or a family arriving at midnight. The 210 we could not take are not a forecast; they are this quarter's count, and most were referred onward to no open bed.

- On 41 nights we ran a waitlist; on 9 we placed guests in overflow motels at our cost.
- Cedar Falls has 150 emergency beds total — all of them ours.

The gap we are carrying

210

people we turned away this quarter — most referred onward to a bed that did not exist.

> *They had no bed, but someone sat with me, made the calls, and found me a couch for the night. That call kept me going.*

— RENATA D., GUEST REFERRED DURING AN APRIL WAITLIST

Outcomes held because placement, not just shelter, is the job we measure.

Beds keep people safe tonight; placements end the crisis. We held 73% housing placement — three points above target — by pairing every bed with a caseworker and a landlord network, even while running full.

- Median stay fell to 38 nights, down from 44 a year ago.
- Nine in ten placed guests were still housed at the six-month follow-up.

Where the money goes · Q2 2026

Eighty-eight cents of every dollar reaches a bed or a placement.

Quarterly expenses of $1.05M against $1.12M in revenue; the surplus rebuilds reserve.

88%
TO PROGRAMS

8%
TO FUNDRAISING

4%
TO ADMINISTRATION

$81
COST PER BED-NIGHT

Strategic plan · 2026–2028

Where the organization grows over three years.

WORKSTREAM	NOW 2026	BUILD 2027	SCALE 2028
Shelter beds	✓ 150	− 280	○ 320
Housing placements	✓ 73%	− 80%	○ 85%
Reserve months	✓ 5.2	− 6.0	○ 6.5
Caseworkers	✓ 6	− 11	○ 13

✓ Shipped − In flight ○ Planned

The plan · 2027

A second building takes us from 150 beds to 280 without diluting outcomes.

280

Beds at full build

UP FROM 150 ✓ +87% BUILD

80%

Placement target held

QUALITY KEPT AT SCALE ✓ TARGET PROGRAMS

6.0

Reserve months

REBUILT POST-LEASE ✓ ON PLAN FINANCE

The Elm Street building is the only path to 280 beds this decade.

A vacant 130-bed care facility on Elm Street is available on a five-year lease at $340K a year. It is two blocks from our caseworker offices, zoned for shelter use, and ready for guests within 90 days of signing.

- No comparable site exists in Cedar Falls; the next opening is years out.
- The lease holds rent flat for five years, well below new-build cost.

Leasing now spends $410K of reserve in year one — and our model funds the rest.

Year-one cost is $340K lease plus $70K fit-out. A committed three-year county contract covers 60% of operating cost; a launched capital campaign covers the balance. Even at half the projected occupancy, the lease breaks even in year two.

- Reserve dips to 3.8 months at signing, then rebuilds to 6.0 by end of 2027.
- Waiting one year cedes the site and the county contract window.

Governance and compliance items for this decision.

- ✓ FY2025 audit filed clean — Compliant
- ✓ Lease reviewed by counsel — Compliant
- ✓ County contract terms confirmed — Compliant
- − Capital-campaign quiet phase underway — 60% of goal
- ○ Board vote on the Elm Street lease — today
- / ~~New-build feasibility study~~ — deferred

We recommend leasing the second shelter now.

LEASE THE ELM STREET BUILDING

Adds 130 beds within 90 days, locks rent flat, and secures the county contract window.

WAIT FOR THE CAPITAL CAMPAIGN

Cedes the only viable site and a year of beds; turn-aways continue at today's pace.

Marcus Hale · Executive Director · board@opendoorshelter.example

No open bed should mean no door — let's open the second one.